Blessed G/Michael catholic secondary school
First semester English Final Exam for grade 11th

January, 2018 E, C **Number of questions: 40** **Time allowed: 55 minutes**

SECTION ONE:-READING COMPREHENSION

Direction:-Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions(1-13)accordingly *(1 pt. each.)*

The concept of **cheap popularity** has become a central theme in social and political discourse, describing the pursuit of instant, widespread approval through superficial means rather than substantive achievement. It is characterized by the use of "low-hanging fruit"—emotional appeals, populist rhetoric, or viral stunts—to gain a following without offering any real value or long-term solutions. While it provides immediate gratification for the seeker, it often leaves a void in its wake, as it is built on a foundation of fleeting trends rather than character or expertise.

The rise of digital hyper-connectivity has accelerated this phenomenon, turning attention into a global currency. On social media platforms, the algorithm frequently rewards "outrage bait" or performative gestures over nuanced debate, encouraging individuals to prioritize "likes" over legacy. This digital environment creates a feedback loop where the loudest and most controversial voices rise to the top, often at the expense of truth or decorum. Consequently, cheap popularity is no longer just a social byproduct; it is a calculated strategy for those unwilling to put in the work required for genuine respect.

In a political arena, cheap popularity often manifests as **populism**. Leaders frequently resort to identifying "enemies" or making grand, unrealistic promises to sway the masses during times of economic or social anxiety. This "bread and circuses" approach distracts the public from systemic issues by providing them with a temporary sense of belonging or victory. However, history shows that such popularity is highly volatile; when the promised miracles fail to materialize; the same crowd that cheered the leader is often the first to turn against them.

Beyond politics, this trend has significantly impacted the cultural landscape, leading to a "dilution of merit." the boundary between being famous and being capable has blurred. When fame is acquired cheaply—through a viral moment or a controversial statement—the incentive to master a craft or pursue higher education diminishes. This creates a cultural vacuum where the most visible members of society are often the least qualified to lead or inspire, prioritizing a polished image over a principled life.

Furthermore, the psychological toll of chasing cheap popularity is profound. Those who build their identity on the shifting sands of public opinion often find themselves in a state of constant anxiety. Because this type of approval is conditional and easily lost, the seeker must continuously escalate their behavior to remain relevant. This leads to a loss of the "authentic self," as the individual becomes a mere reflection of what they believe the crowd wants to see, eventually resulting in burnout or public disgrace when the facade inevitably cracks.

Ultimately, the antidote to cheap popularity is a return to substantive engagement and long-term vision. Genuine influence is earned through consistency, integrity, and the courage to hold unpopular opinions when they are right. While the shortcut to fame may be tempting, it lacks the resilience to withstand the tests of time and crisis. True leadership and respect are not found in the roar of a temporary crowd, but in the quiet, steady impact of actions that improve the lives of others long after the trending hashtags have faded.

1. What is the primary message of the first paragraph?
   A. Cheap popularity is a long-term strategy for success.
   B. Cheap popularity relies on superficial appeals rather than real value.
   C. Viral stunts are the only way to gain approval in 2026.
   D. Instant gratification is more important than expertise.

2. According to the second paragraph, how do digital algorithms influence behavior?
   A. They promote nuanced and balanced debate.
   B. They reward controversial "outrage bait" to maximize engagement.
   C. They encourage individuals to pursue higher education.
   D. They hide people who seek "likes" over legacy.

3. In the context of politics, what is the main consequence of "cheap popularity"?
   A. It provides lasting solutions to systemic economic issues.
   B. It fosters a deep sense of belonging for all citizens.
   C. It uses populist rhetoric to distract the public from real problems.
   D. It strengthens the character of national leaders.

4. How does the text describe the "dilution of merit" in modern culture?
   A. Education is now the primary driver of viral success.
   B. Mastery of a craft has become easier due to social media.
   C. Fame is increasingly disconnected from actual capability or skill.
   D. Famous people are always the most qualified to lead.

5. What does the author suggest about the volatility of populist leadership?
   A. Populist leaders remain popular forever.
   B. Crowds are consistently loyal to miracle-making leaders.
   C. Populism is the most stable form of governance in 2026
   D. Supporters may quickly turn against a leader when promises aren't met.

6. According to the fifth paragraph, why do those chasing cheap popularity experience anxiety?
   A. Because they have too many genuine friends.
   B. Because they refuse to use social media.
   C. Because they are too focused on their "authentic self."
   D. Because their self-worth is dependent on conditional public approval.

A 7. The text characterizes "low-hanging fruit" as:

A. Easy emotional appeals used to gain quick approval. C. A sustainable agricultural practice.

B. Hard-earned professional achievements D. Nuanced scientific theories.

A 8. What is the intended tone of this article?

A. Critical and cautionary C. Humorous and lighthearted

B. Celebratory and encouraging D. Indifferent and technical.

A 9. Which statement best summarizes the author's view on genuine influence?

A. It is earned through consistency and the courage to be right even when unpopular.

B. It can be bought or faked using the right digital currency.

C. It is synonymous with having the most followers on social media.

D. It is easily achieved by mirroring whatever a crowd wants to hear.

B 10. In paragraph 1, the word "substantive" most nearly means:

A. Extremely loud B. Meaningful and based on facts. C. Fast-moving. D. Popular among youth.

11. In paragraph 3, what is meant by "populism"?

A. A scientific study of population growth.

B. A government system where everyone is famous

C. Appealing to the emotions and prejudices of ordinary people.

D. The process of moving from rural to urban areas.

A 12. In paragraph 6, the word "resilience" refers to:

A. The ability to withstand or recover quickly from difficulties. C. The act of following a hashtag

B. The speed at which one becomes famous. D. The cost of building a digital platform.

C 13. In Paragraph 2, the word "this" (in "this phenomenon...") refers to:

A. Character or expertise. B. Global currency C. The rise of cheap popularity. D. Substance.

SECTION THREE:-LANGUGE FOCUS

DIRECTION: Choose the most appropriate among the alternatives given for each of the questions.

C 14. The teacher noticed the students ___ during the lecture.

A. sleep B. slept C. sleeping D. to sleep

C 15. She looked ___ after hearing the bad news.

A. shock B. shocking C. shocked D. shocks

C 16. I remember to visit the museum. This sentence implies

A. memory of a past experience C. not forget to visit it

B. recalling the memory now D. I have a memory of the visit

B 17. The teacher gave a ___ explanation of the topic.

A. confuse B. confusing C. confused D. confusion

A 18. Which one of the following sentences has dangling participle error?

A. Walking down the street, the big trees looked beautiful

B. The documents signed by the manager are confidential

C. Having finished his homework, he went out to play.

D. Walking down the road, I saw the tree fall.

B 19. By the end of the year, he _____ the country.

A. will leave B. will have left C. leave D. is living

A 20. Economic crises can _____ political instability.

A. result from B. now that C. owing to D.as long as

B 21. The teacher _____ the class when the students arrived.

A. already started B. had already started C. starts D. was starting

B 22. **FATHER:** What did the doctor say?

SON: He advised me _____ more water.

A. drink B. to drink C. drinking D. drunk

B 23. The protest was _____ as both sides refused to compromise on the primary issue.

A. productive B. inconclusive C. brief D. spontaneous

B 24. He's interested in _____ French.

A.to learn B. learning C. learn D. learns

D 25. Which sentence correctly uses verb and verb pattern?

A. I enjoy to read novels.

B. She suggested to go to the museum.

C. They want visiting their grandparents

D. He admitted telling the secret to someone.

A 26. "Please help me," she said. Choose the correct indirect speech.

A. She asked me to help her.

B. She asked me help her.

C. She said please to help her.

D. She asked to help her.

C 27. _____ you have completed your homework, you can watch TV.

A. Even though B. Unless C. Now that D. Despite

B 28. I will support your decision _____ it does not harm anyone else.

A. when B.as long as C. in case D. though

B 29. **Student A:** Is Sara coming to the party?

Student B : No, she refused _____ because she has to study.

A. come B. to come C. coming D. came

B 30. **Teacher:** Shall I explain this grammar rule again?

Student: _____ I think I've understood it now.

A. No, you shouldn't.

B. That's not necessary, thanks.

C. I don't want to hear it.

D. Yes, explain it.

WRITING: Choose the most appropriate answer for each of the questions

a. Stress can appear in muscle tension, palpitation, and high blood pressure.

b. Professionals under stress behave as perfectionists.

c. This may lead to depression, lethargy, and reduced work capacity.

d. Self-destructive behaviors such as excessive eating, drinking, or smoking are observed.

D 31. When you arrange sentences (a-d) logically for coherence, it will be:

A. a-b-c-d B. b-a-d-c C. a-d-b-c D. a-b-d-c

A 32. I remember the match between grade 12 and grade 11. One of the players in the team got a yellow card. Surprisingly, this player also tore his outfit during the match, but the referee….."

A. Narrative B. Descriptive C. Argumentative D. Expository

B 33. To properly install the new software, first ensure your device is connected to a stable power source. Next, download the executable file from the official portal and double-click to begin the setup wizard. Follow the on-screen prompts until the progress bar reaches 100%.

A .Argumentative B. Expository C. Narrative D. Descriptive

A 34. Social media platforms must be held legally responsible for the spread of misinformation. When algorithms Prioritize engagement over truth, they threaten the very foundations of democracy, and only strict regulation can restore public trust. "What type of writing is this?

A. Argumentative B. Narrative C. Descriptive D. Expository

D 35. "It was 7 years ago. She caught my entire body. Her charming eyes, approach and long hair were my mind's stealers. She had a waist which looks like an island in the middle of a sea." This is more likely——type of writing.

A. Narrative B. Expository C. Argumentative D. Descriptive

Sentence comprehension

Choose the sentence that is similar or nearly similar to the original sentence

B 36. The constant criticism was reducing his confidence in his ability to succeed, yet he refused to surrender to despair."

What does the phrase "refused to surrender to despair" imply about the subject's character?

A. He was delusional about his prospects. C. He ignored the criticism completely.

B. He was resilient despite facing negativity. D. He was too proud to ask for help.

C 37. "Because of his proclivity for high-risk investments, he often found himself in financial trouble."

A. He became rich because he avoided risky investments.

B. He had a natural fear of losing money in the stock market.

C. His natural tendency to take big financial risks often led to money problems.

D. He only invested in safe, government-backed bonds.

C 38. The project was feasible only if the government provided the necessary subsidies.

A. The project was impossible regardless of government help.

B. The government refused to help, but the project was still a success.

C. The project's success depended entirely on receiving government financial aid.

D. The project was so easy that it didn't require any funding.

C 39. His laconic reply suggested that he was either very busy or simply uninterested in the conversation.

A. He gave a very long and detailed explanation of his day.

B. He was so excited to talk that he wouldn't let anyone else speak.

C. His very short and brief answer showed he had no time or desire to talk.

D. He was very rude and yelled at the person asking the question.

C 40. The novel's poignant ending left the readers in tears.

A. The ending of the story was so funny that everyone laughed.

B. The ending was very boring and no one finished the book.

C. The ending was deeply moving and touched the readers' emotions.

D. The book had a very scary ending that gave people nightmares.

38 B
40 C
Excellent!

English Answer Sheet G. 11 **Time allotted: 55'**

Name Makarem Merole Sec. 12C No. 53

1. B	11. C	21. B	31. C B
2. B	12. A	22. B	32. A
3. B C	13. C	23. B	33. B
4. C D	14. C	24. B	34. A
5. D	15. C	25. D	35. D
6. D	16. C	26. A	36. B
7. A	17. B	27. C	37. C
8. A	18. A	28. B	38. C
9. A	19. B	29. B	39. C
10. B	20. A	30. B	40. C